

3 Cases Where a ViewModel Is a Must

1. Security Case

- You should never send your full Entity Model to the View when it contains sensitive fields such as PasswordHash, IsAdmin, or Salary.
- A ViewModel allows you to expose **only the necessary properties** (e.g., UserName, Email) and keep critical data hidden.

2. Combining Multiple Models

- Sometimes a single View requires data from different entities.
- Example: A “Department Details” page needs department info, a list of students, and the calculated department state.
- A ViewModel can **aggregate** all of this into one object for the View.

3. Shaping Data for the View

- The View might need data in a different structure than your database entity.
- Example: For a DropDownList, you only need Id and Name, while your Student entity contains many fields.
- A ViewModel provides a **simplified shape** that matches exactly what the View requires.